

A fair response to applicant AI use

Quick reference | Published rules before suspicion

1 State what is permitted

Define editing, brainstorming, translation, accessibility support, and substantive generation. Explain the boundary with examples before the application cycle.

2 Make disclosure workable

Specify which uses require a brief statement. Do not require passwords, private chat histories, medical information, or paid software. Offer an accessible way to explain the work.

3 Treat detector output as uncertain

An AI-writing percentage is not a probability of misconduct. Human writing can be flagged; AI writing can be missed. Performance depends on tool and context.

4 Identify the actual concern

Locate the specific published rule and relevant evidence. A polished style or detector flag alone does not establish a violation. Do not impose a new rule retroactively.

5 Give a fair response path

Describe the concern neutrally. Offer time and an accessible method to respond. Name the decision owner and a review or appeal route.

6 Keep the decision human

Do not deny an award or establish misconduct using a detector score alone. Document the evidence and reasoning under the published policy.

Sources: Turnitin detection FAQ (reviewed September 24, 2026); Liang et al., Patterns (2023); Al Ali, Helcl & Libovicky, EACL SRW (2026). See the hub for scope and interpretation.

Open the policy starter and fictional response scenario

Adapt with organizational policy, privacy, accessibility, and legal owners. This is a workshop framework, not official NSPA policy.